



CESAB
CENTRE DE SYNTHÈSE ET D'ANALYSE
SUR LA BIODIVERSITÉ

INTRODUCTION AUX MÉTA-ANALYSES ET REVUES SYSTÉMATIQUES

Making Sense of Your Corpus: Choosing the Right Visualizations

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Revue systématique et synthèses »

SOUTIENS INSTITUTIONNELS

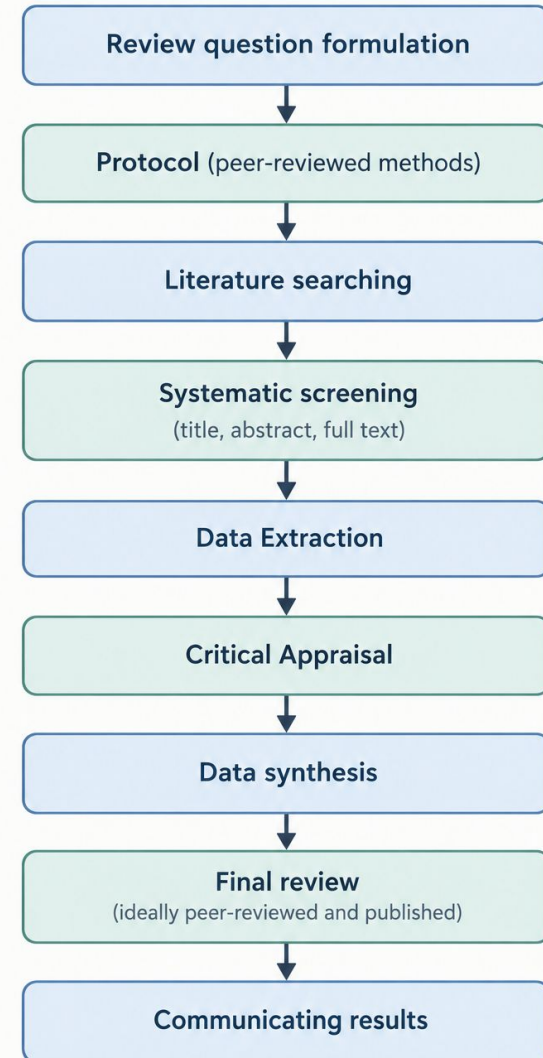


Making sense of your data

The visualization step

Once the evidence base is finalized, numerous possibilities for representation exist

- You'll need to make choices about the most relevant data
- Make choices about the most suitable forms of visualization



What do the CEE guidelines say?

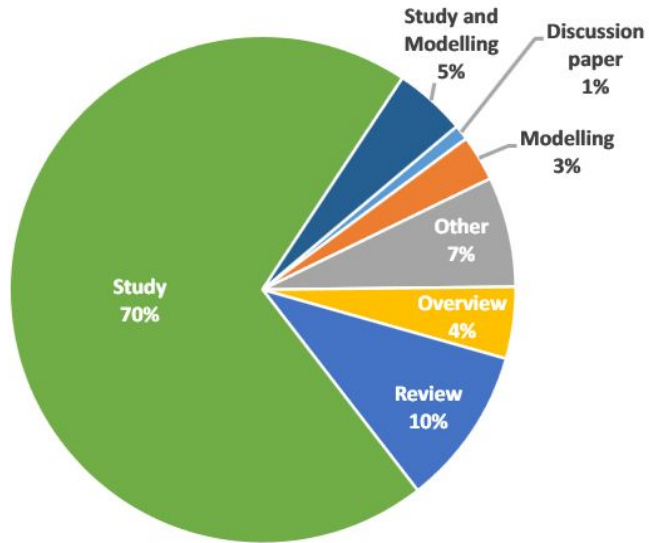
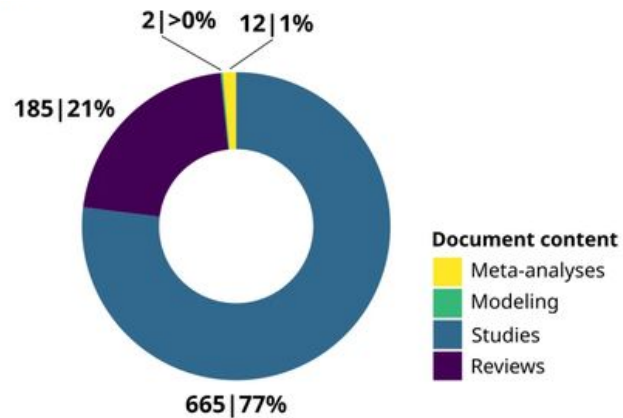
8.3.2 Mapping and data visualisation

- The process of mapping and presentation of data can take many forms [...] (see James et al 2016 for a detailed discussion of methodologies for the production of Systematic Maps).
- Presentation of maps can range from a simple ***spreadsheet format*** to ***innovative forms of data visualisation*** that make the evidence base easier to interrogate and extract information of interest to the user.
- Recording of **key characteristics of each study** included in a narrative synthesis is vital if the Systematic Map is to be useful in summarising the evidence base. Key characteristics stated in the Protocol must be fully presented in at least tabular form.

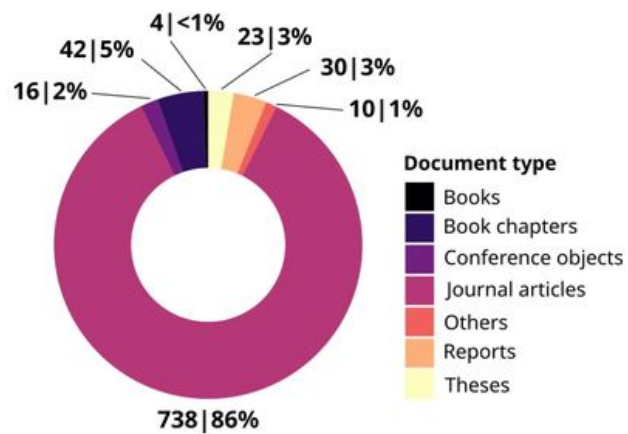
e.g. a minimum list of characteristics

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|
| • Article reference | • Subject population |
| • Intervention/exposure variable | • Setting/context |
| • Outcome measures | • Methodological design |

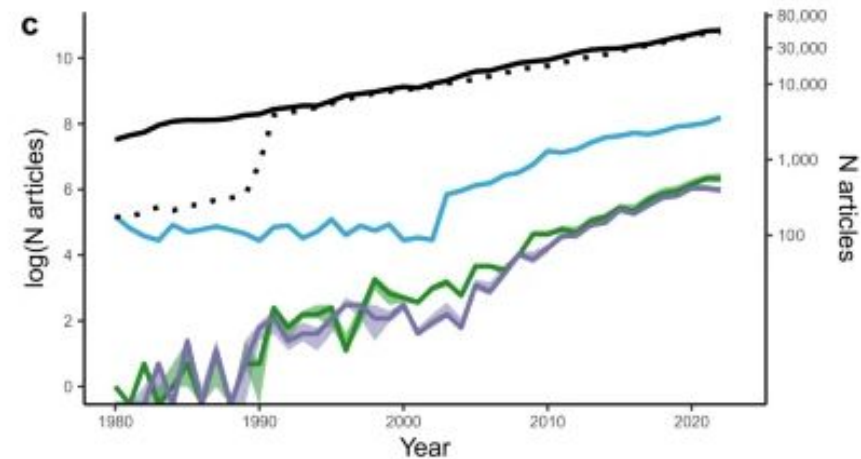
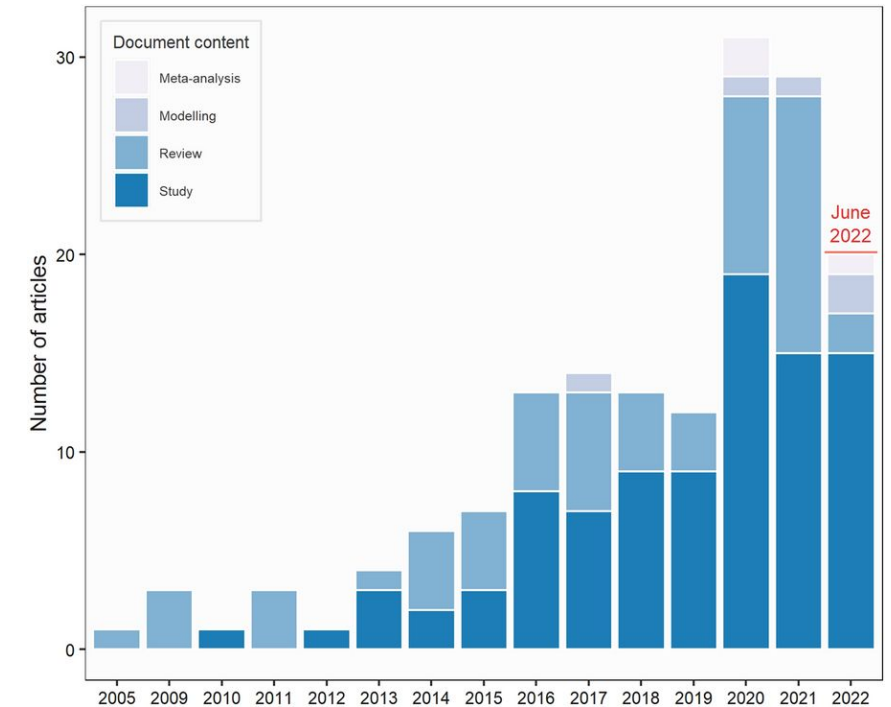
Article reference



Langridge et al. 2022. *Environ. Evid.*

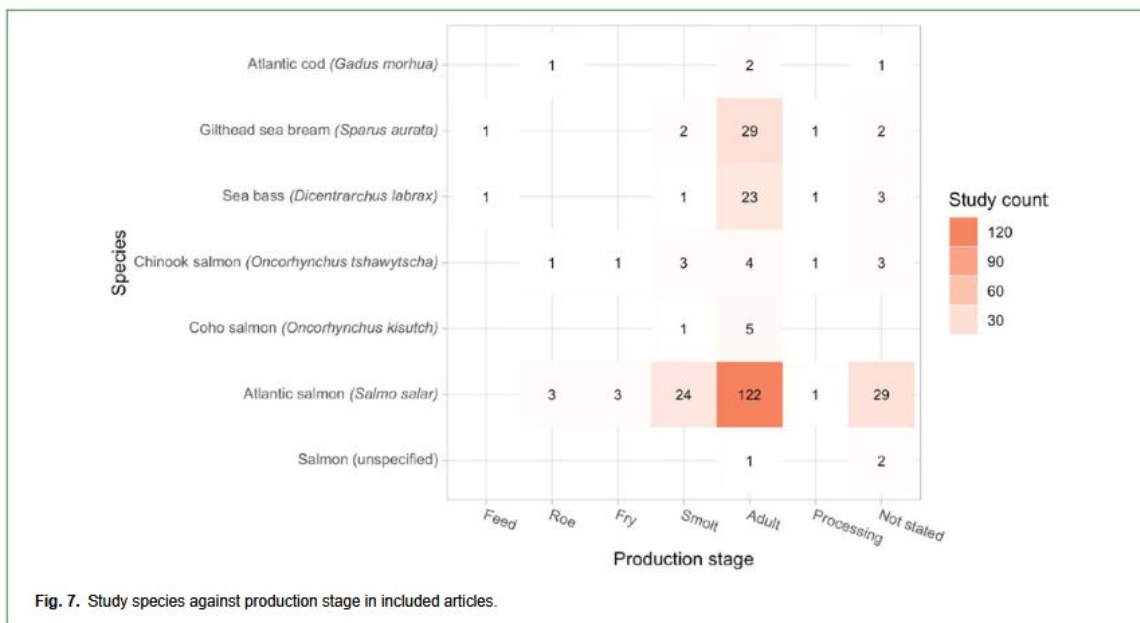


Terray et al. 2025. *Environ. Evid.*

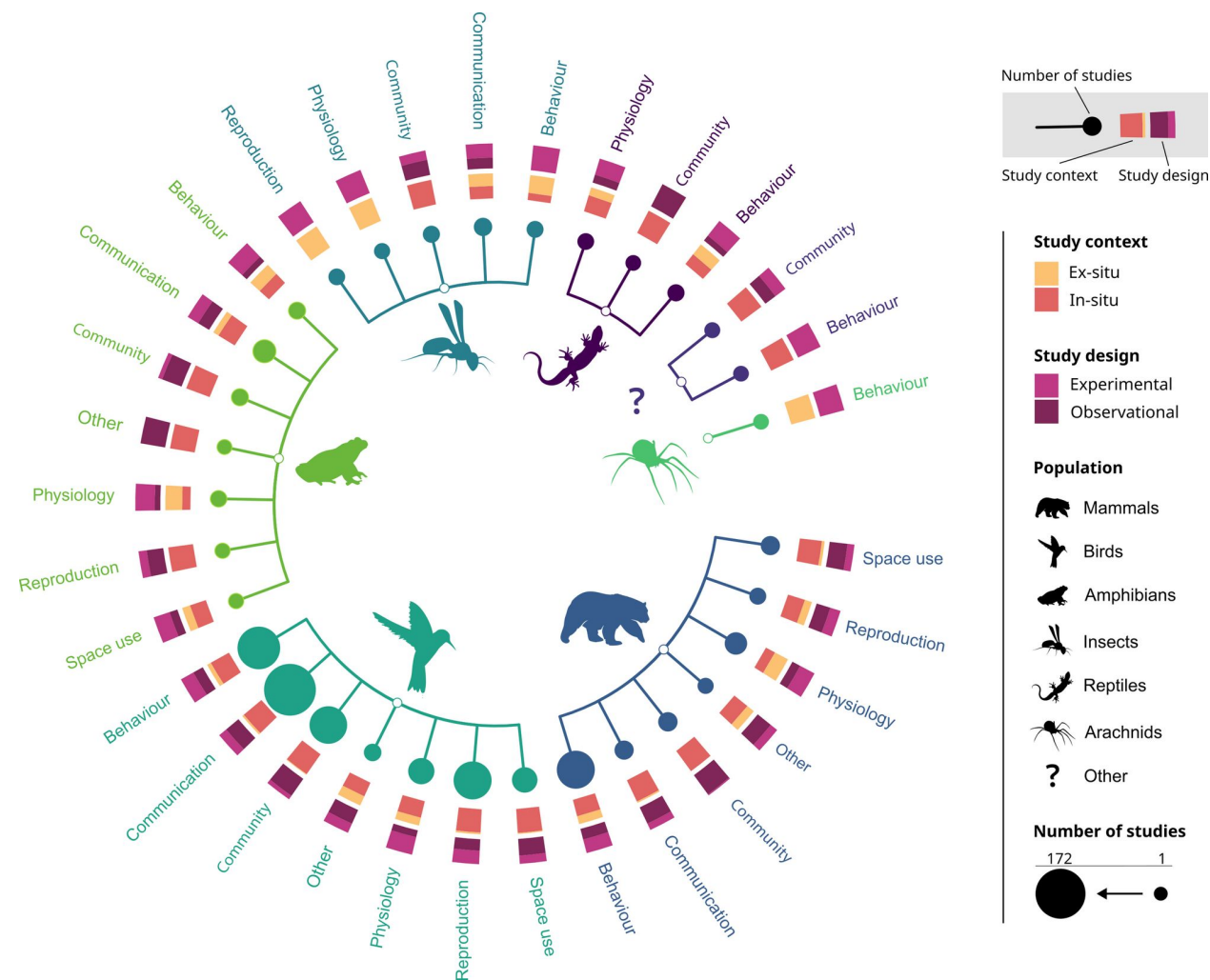


Veytia et al. 2025. *npj Ocean Sustain.*

Subject population



Haddaway *et al.* 2026. *CABI Agric. Biosci.*

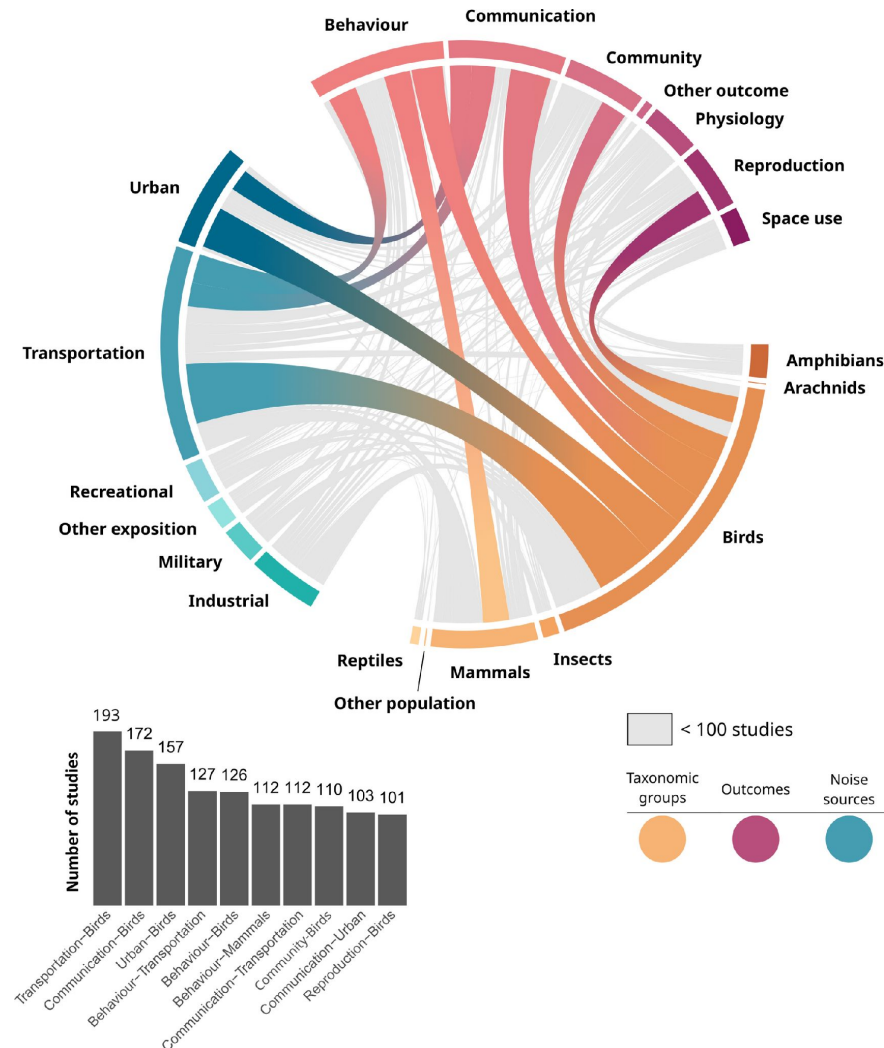


Terray *et al.* 2025. *Environ. Evid.*

Intervention/exposure variable

Cross-tabulating data : population x exposure x outcome

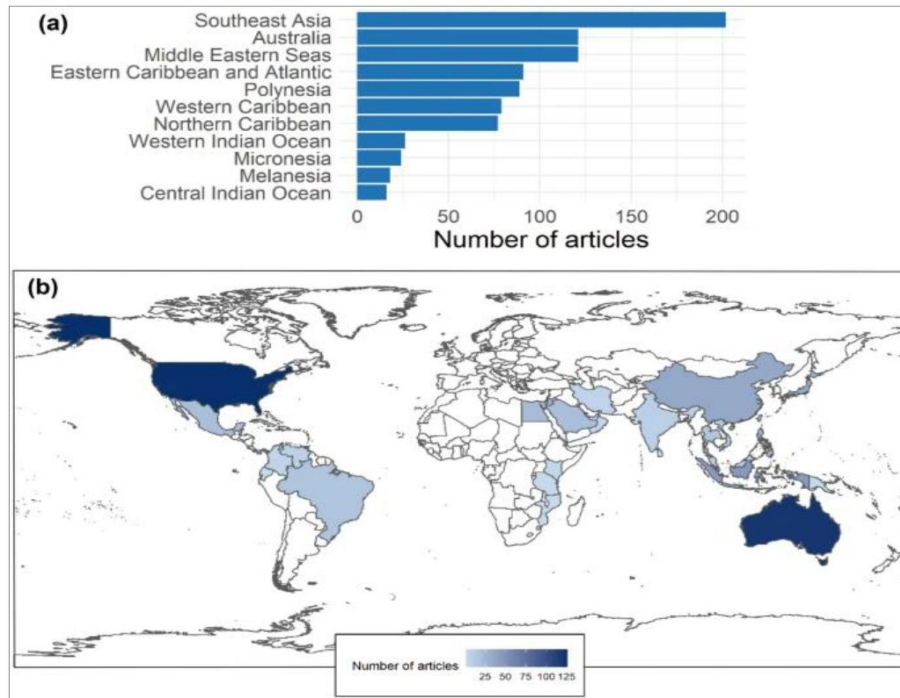
...but cross
tabulating **data
categories** can be very
appealing



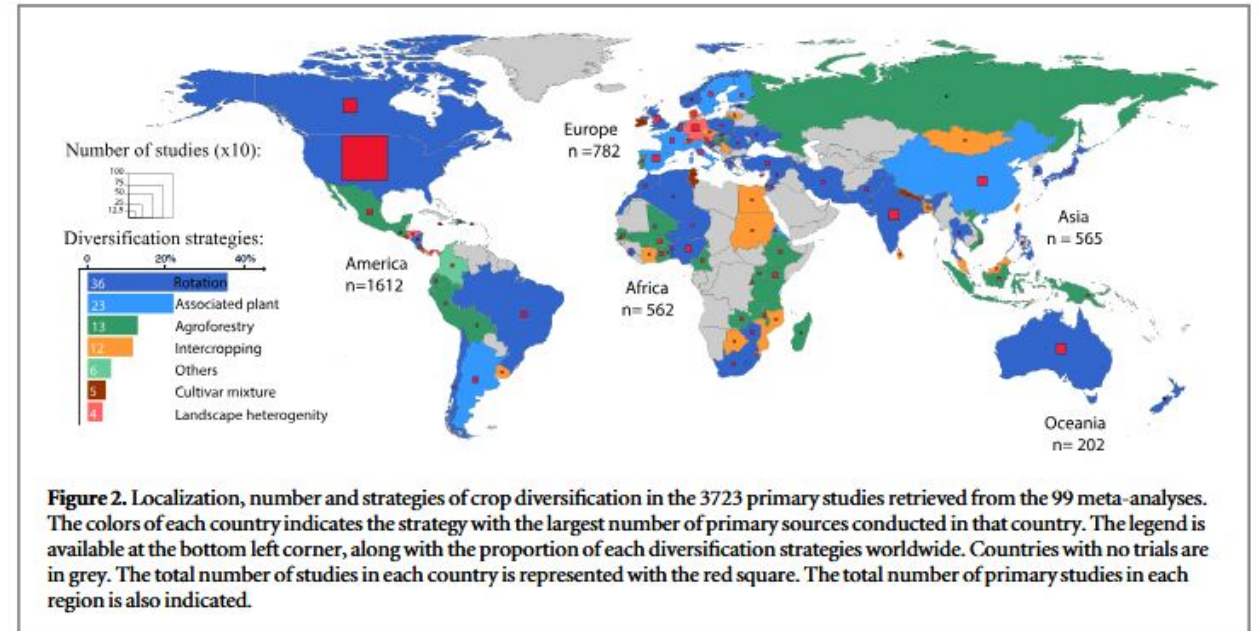
Terray *et al.* 2025. *Environ. Evid.*

Setting/context

Spatial distribution of articles/studies

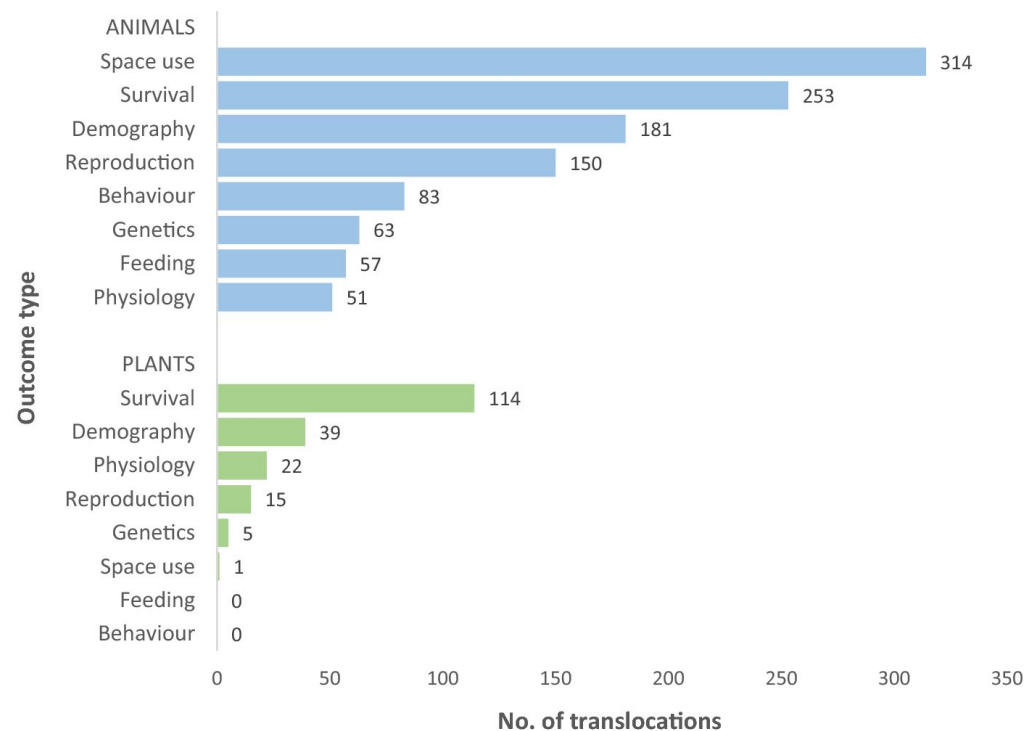


Ouédraogo et al., 2021. *Environ. Evid.*

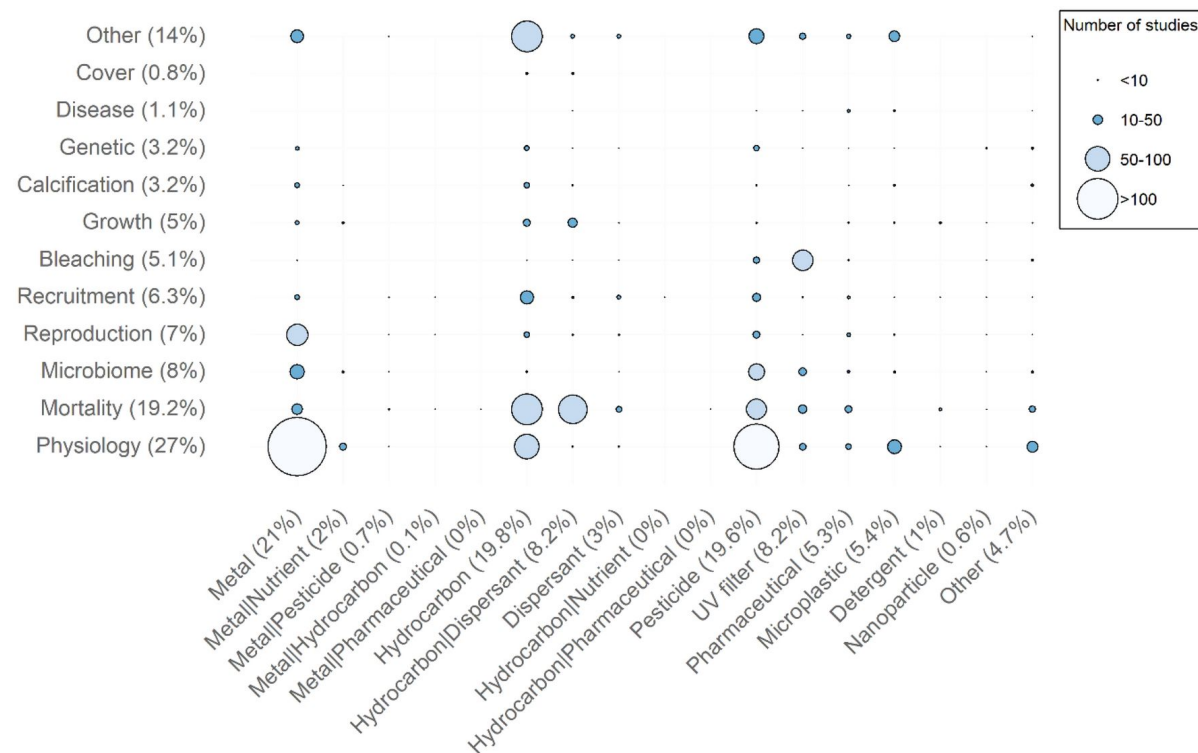


Beillouin et al. 2019. *Environ. Res. Lett.*

Outcome measures



Langridge *et al.* 2022. *Environ. Evid.*



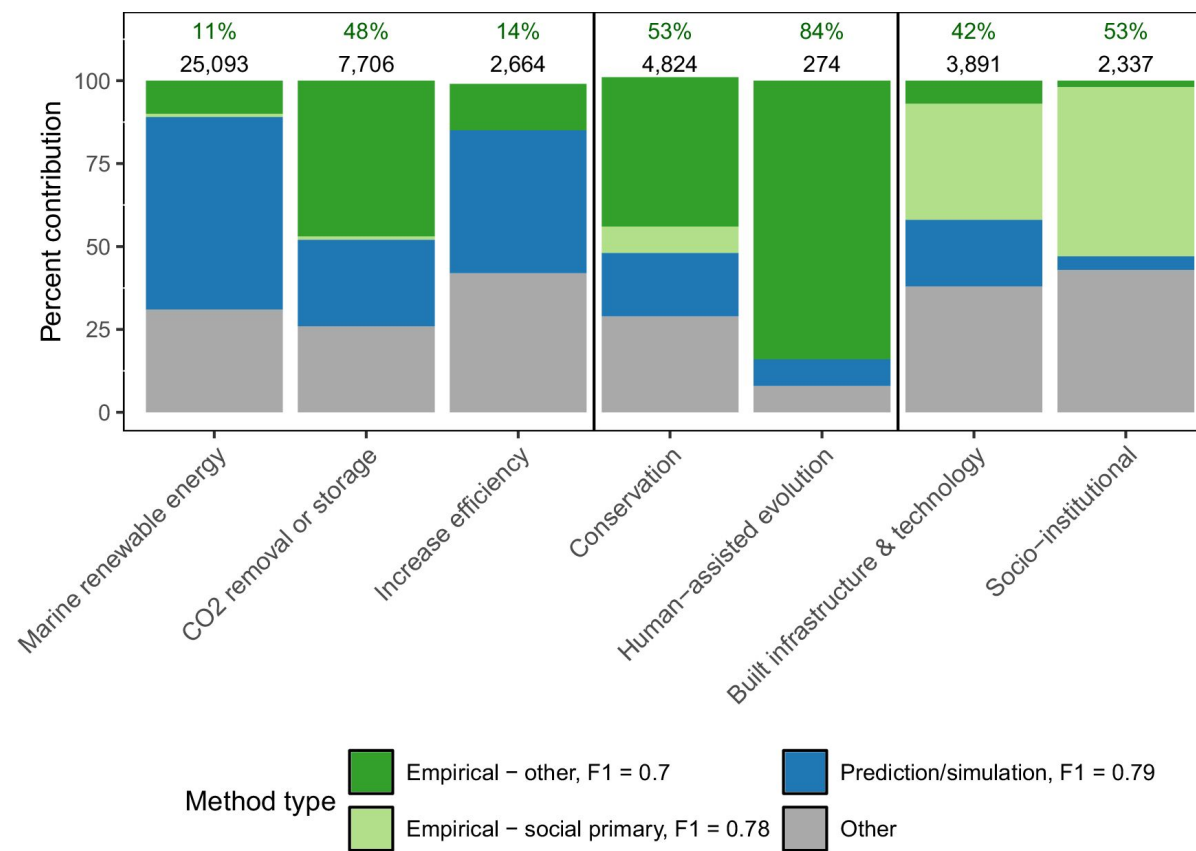
Ouédraogo *et al.*, 2021. *Environ. Evid.*

...again, why not cross
tabulate **data**
categories?

Methodological design

Outcome x methods

...and again...



Veytia et al. 2025. *npj Ocean Sustain.*